GUIDED CHILDHOOD · PRINT AT HOME

Earn Your Screen Time

A chart that turns screen time into a deal: earned first, agreed together, enjoyed in full.



Ages 5 to 7 chart

Ages 8 to 11 chart

Cut out tokens

TWO MINUTES BEFORE YOU PRINT

How this chart works, and why it is not a bribe

You are not paying your child to behave. You are making a deal visible. Screens are part of childhood now, and pretending otherwise starts a fight you cannot win. What children need is a clear, warm path: here is how screen time is earned, here is how much a token is worth, and here is how we end well. When the deal is on the fridge, you stop being the referee. The chart is.

AGES 5 TO 7

Reward daily. Young children live in today. Count stars together at teatime, hand over tokens straight away, and let them spend them the same evening. Three stars earns one token. Six stars earns two.

AGES 8 TO 11

Reward weekly. Older children can hold a bigger deal. Tally the week on Sunday, pay out stars, and let them choose how to spend from the menu on their chart. Saving up is allowed and worth praising.

THE FIVE HOUSE RULES OF THE CHART

1. Set the rows together on Sunday. A chart done to a child gets ignored. A chart built with a child gets defended by them.
2. Earned tokens are never taken back. Consequences live elsewhere. The chart only ever pays out.
3. Tokens are minutes, and minutes are honoured. If a token says 15 minutes, the timer says 15 minutes.
4. Use the ending well card five minutes before time is up. Endings are where the battles live, so we rehearse them.
5. Keep it warm. The chart is a game the family wins together, not a surveillance system.

Print the charts on A4, laminate them if you can, and tick with a dry wipe pen so one print lasts all year. The token sheet prints best on card.

AGES 5 TO 7 · MY WEEK

My name is _____



Hi, I am Pebble! Stopping is hard when I am having fun. My tokens make it fair. Colour a star for every win, and let's earn our screen time together!

My wins	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
I got dressed by myself	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
Teeth brushed, morning and night	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
I played away from screens	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
I read or shared a book	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
I helped at home	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆
I used kind words today	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆	☆

Count my stars at teatime!

3 stars = 1 token · 6 stars = 2 tokens

AGES 8 TO 11 · MY WEEK

Boss of my screen: _____



Be the boss of your screen, not the other way round. I earn my stars first, then I enjoy every minute with zero nagging. Tick your wins, tally on Sunday. Deal?

The deal	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat	Sun
Ready on time, no chasing							
Homework done before screens							
Read 15 minutes							
An hour of moving about							
Helped without being asked							
Screens parked at wind down time							

SUNDAY TALLY

Every tick = 1 star

My total this week: _____

SPEND YOUR STARS

10 stars = 30 extra weekend minutes · 20 stars = film night, you pick

30 stars = a mate over for a gaming hour · 40 stars = family day out, your choice

CUT OUT · PRINT ON CARD IF YOU CAN

Screen tokens

Cut along the dashed lines. A token handed over is a promise kept, so the timer matches the token, and earned tokens are never taken back.

10 MINUTES	10 MINUTES	10 MINUTES	10 MINUTES	10 MINUTES
15 MINUTES	15 MINUTES	15 MINUTES	15 MINUTES	15 MINUTES
30 MINUTES	30 MINUTES	FAMILY SWAP A TREAT	FAMILY SWAP A TREAT	FAMILY SWAP A TREAT

The family swap token turns screen minutes into a shared treat instead: a bake, a park trip, a board game. When a child chooses one unprompted, that is the chart quietly doing its real job.

THE SECRET WEAPON · CUT OUT AND KEEP BY THE SOFA

The ending well cards

Endings are where the battles live. These two cards rehearse them until they are boring, which is exactly what you want.



FIVE MINUTES LEFT

Five minutes to go!
Finish your level. Save your game.
No new episodes start now.

Parent: hand this card over silently. The card is the messenger, so you are not the baddie.



TIME IS UP

Screen off. One big breath in... and out.
High five. You ended well!
That is a star for tomorrow's chart.

Ending well today earns the first star of tomorrow. The loop closes itself.

WHY A BREATHING BEAT WORKS

Switching off mid game feels to a child like being yanked out of a swimming pool. One slow breath is the towel. It gives the brain a beat to arrive back in the room, and it turns the ending into a small win you can praise instead of a fight you have to referee.